

Activity 2: Build Your First Skill

As we're not using Claude Code (which requires a paid setup), we simulate "skills" by combining Projects + Instructions. Instead of executable workflows, we define clear instructions and structured prompts inside a project so our AI can consistently follow a repeatable process, essentially mimicking how a skill would behave, just without automatic triggering.

Step 1: Pick a Simple Use Case

- Resume bullet improver
- Interview answer generator
- LinkedIn message writer
- Job description summariser
- Cover letter enhancer

Step 2: Create a New ChatGPT Project

Inside the Project:

- Go to "Instructions"
- This is where your "Skill" will live

Step 3: Define the Skill Logic (ICCO)

Paste this into **Instructions**:

When the user asks to [your task], perform the following:

Then fill in:

- **Instruction**
 - [What should the AI do?]
- **Context**
 - [Who is the user? What situation?]
- **Constraints**
 - [Limit length]
 - [Tone / style]
 - [Things to avoid]
- **Output format**
 - [Bullet points / table / JSON]

Tip: You can ask ChatGPT for assistance as well.

Step 4: Test Your Skill

Try a simple input:

- “Rewrite: Helped with marketing campaign”
- “Draft a LinkedIn message to a hiring manager”

Note: Focus on whether the output is actually useful, not just “sounds good”

Step 5: Evaluate

- Is the output too generic?
- Did the AI understand the target user?
- Are constraints being followed?
- Is the output format usable?